Scale Exercises - Section II, Level 17

Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two-Octave Six-String Neck Ladder

24 groups. 96 notes. One pick cycle.

Carry the Level 16 four-note overlap across all six strings and both octaves before shifting one fret.

1. Expand the sequence

Use 12 ascending groups and 12 descending groups. The rolling line now spans scale positions 1 through 15.

2. Preserve the four-note pulse

Every group begins on the same pick stroke. Continue through group seams, string changes, both octaves, and the turn.

3. Shift only after note 96

Return to the low root, release pressure, and move the complete hand-and-thumb frame exactly one fret.

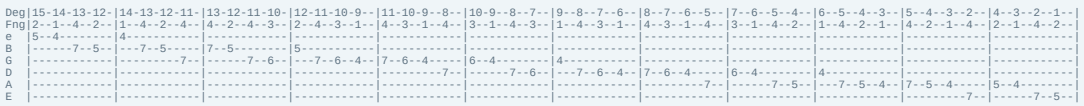
Worked example - A major at low-E fret 5

Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A. The high root repeats at the turn.

UP: 1234 | 2345 | ... | 12-13-14-15 **DOWN: 15-14-13-12 | 14-13-12-11 | ... | 4321**

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



KEY ROUTE A -> Bb -> B -> C -> Db -> D -> Eb -> E -> F -> Gb -> G -> Ab -> A, then reverse.

AUDIT Hear 24 equal groups; make every crossing, octave root, repeated high root, and frame shift invisible.

This is the complete two-octave expansion of the Level 16 four-note rolling sequence.

Session protocol

1. Master the 12 ascending groups in A major.
2. Master the 12 descending groups in A major.
3. Link both halves without resetting at the high root.
4. Start 15-20 BPM below your clean Level 16 tempo.
5. Use 2-3 neighboring rungs; pause one beat after each cell.
6. Remove the pause; connect the full route both ways.

Section II now combines the four-note rolling sequence with the complete two-octave major-scale frame.

Level 17 - Chromatic Major-Key Route and Two-Octave Sequence Map

Ascending route: complete one 96-note rolling cell, then move the frame +1 fret

Descending route: use the same cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

Rung	Key	Low-E root	Frame	Scale tones (degrees 1-7)
01	A major	fret 5	4-7	A B C# D E F# G#
02	Bb major	fret 6	5-8	Bb C D Eb F G A
03	B major	fret 7	6-9	B C# D# E F# G# A#
04	C major	fret 8	7-10	C D E F G A B
05	Db major	fret 9	8-11	Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C
06	D major	fret 10	9-12	D E F# G A B C#
07	Eb major	fret 11	10-13	Eb F G Ab Bb C D
08	E major	fret 12	11-14	E F# G# A B C# D#
09	F major	fret 13	12-15	F G A Bb C D E
10	Gb major	fret 14	13-16	Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F
11	G major	fret 15	14-17	G A B C D E F#
12	Ab major	fret 16	15-18	Ab Bb C Db Eb F G
13	A major - octave	fret 17	16-19	A B C# D E F# G#

How to use the map

Up pass:
rungs 01-13.

Turn:
complete the high-A cell at fret 17, then reverse.

Down pass:
rungs 12-01. Do not replay rung 13 unless beginning a new round.

Sixteenth pulse:
one four-note group per beat; never pause between groups.

Goal:
hear one connected two-octave line rather than 24 isolated fragments.

Sequence anatomy

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UP:   01-02-03-04 | 02-03-04-05 | 03-04-05-06 | 04-05-06-07 | 05-06-07-08 | 06-07-08-09
      07-08-09-10 | 08-09-10-11 | 09-10-11-12 | 10-11-12-13 | 11-12-13-14 | 12-13-14-15

DOWN: 15-14-13-12 | 14-13-12-11 | 13-12-11-10 | 12-11-10-09 | 11-10-09-08 | 10-09-08-07
      09-08-07-06 | 08-07-06-05 | 07-06-05-04 | 06-05-04-03 | 05-04-03-02 | 04-03-02-01
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Mastery gate

Name every key, preserve the four-note pulse across all six strings, land every one-fret shift silently, and complete both pick starts on separate days.

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 01-02: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

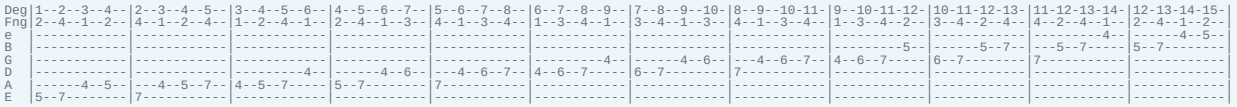
01 A MAJOR

ROOT E5 | FRAME 4-7

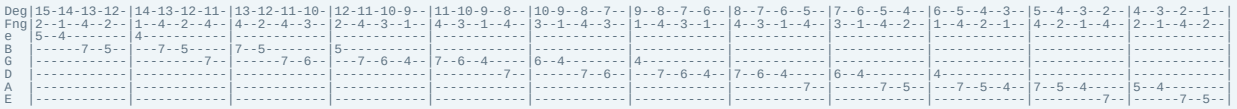
Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

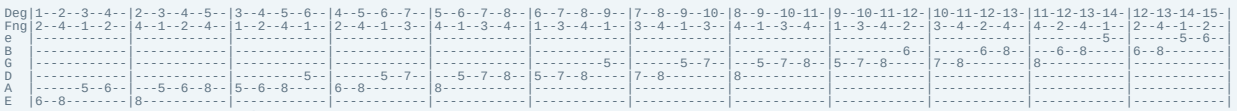
02 BB MAJOR

ROOT E6 | FRAME 5-8

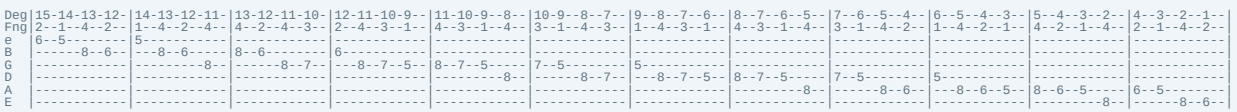
Scale tones: Bb C D Eb F G A Bb C D Eb F G A Bb

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 03-04: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

03 B MAJOR

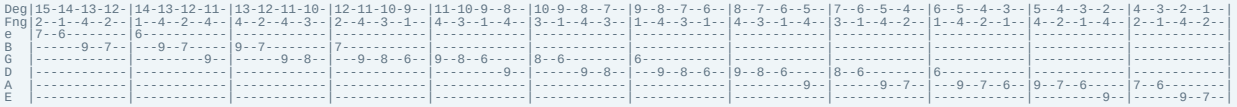
ROOT E7 | FRAME 6-9

Scale tones: B C# D# E F# G# A# B C# D# E F# G# A# B

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

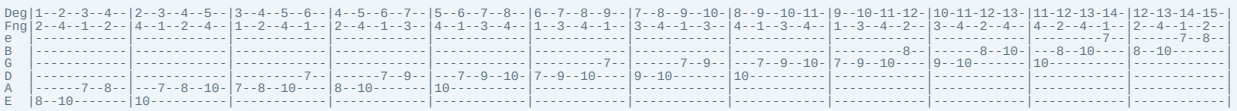
04 C MAJOR

ROOT E8 | FRAME 7-10

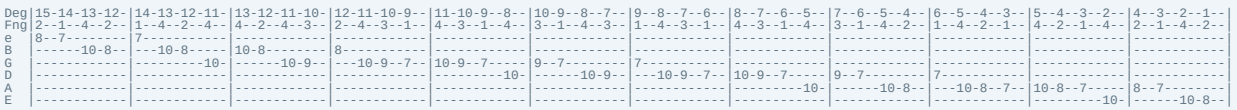
Scale tones: C D E F G A B C D E F G A B C

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 05-06: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

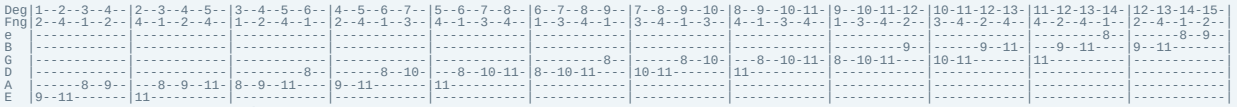
05 DB MAJOR

ROOT E9 | FRAME 8-11

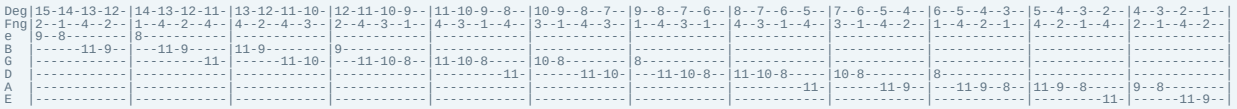
Scale tones: Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

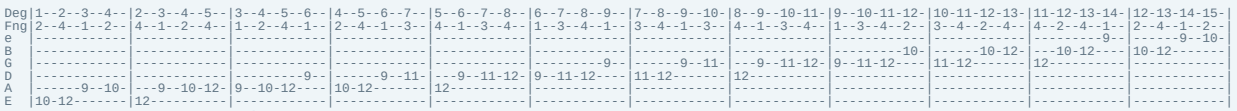
06 D MAJOR

ROOT E10 | FRAME 9-12

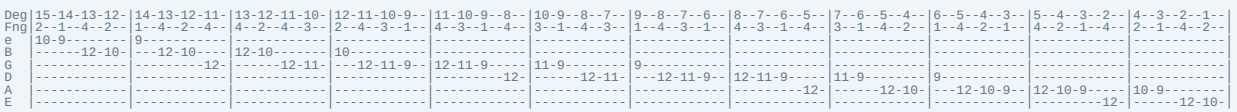
Scale tones: D E F# G A B C# D E F# G A B C# D

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 07-08: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

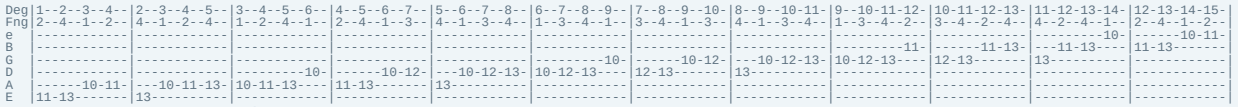
07 EB MAJOR

ROOT E11 | FRAME 10-13

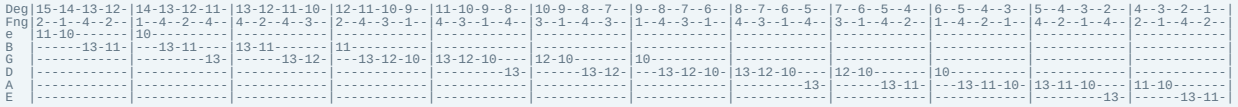
Scale tones: Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb F G Ab Bb C D Eb

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

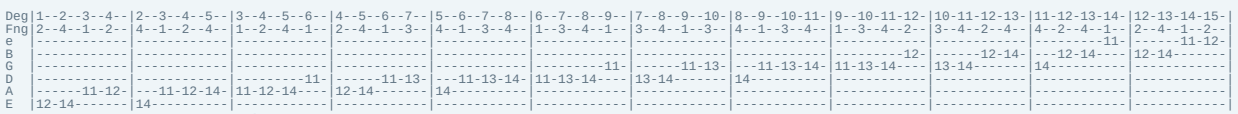
08 E MAJOR

ROOT E12 | FRAME 11-14

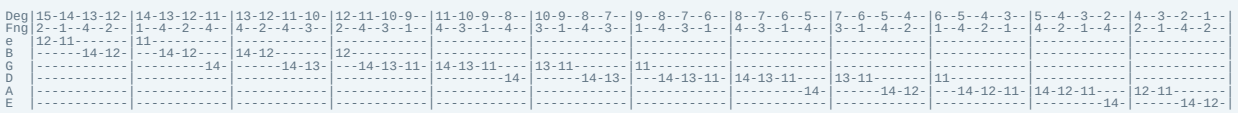
Scale tones: E F# G# A B C# D# E F# G# A B C# D# E

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 09-10: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

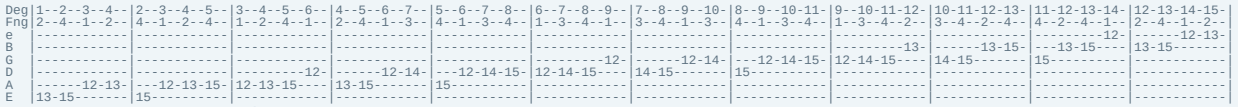
09 F MAJOR

ROOT E13 | FRAME 12-15

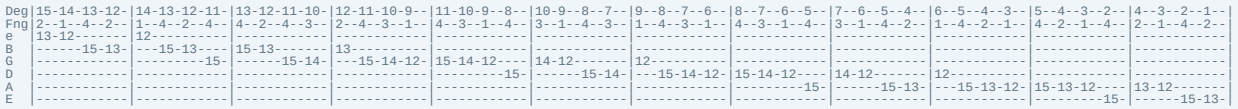
Scale tones: F G A Bb C D E F G A Bb C D E F

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

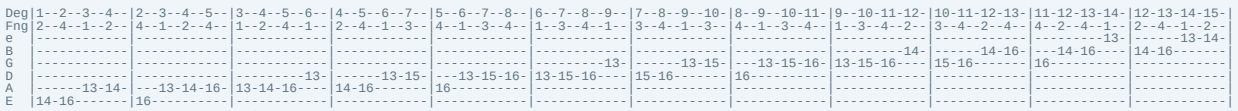
10 GB MAJOR

ROOT E14 | FRAME 13-16

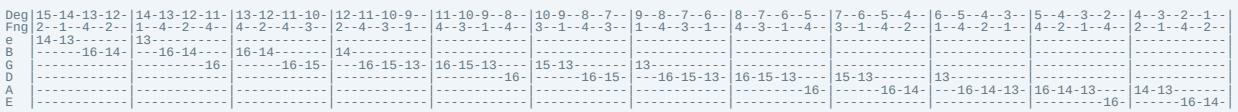
Scale tones: Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb Cb Db Eb F Gb

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Major Scale Four-Note Rolling Sequence: Two Octaves

Rungs 11-12: play each card as one 24-group cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

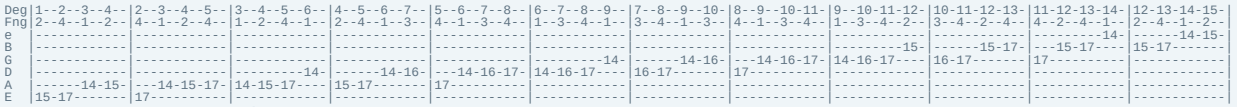
11 G MAJOR

ROOT E15 | FRAME 14-17

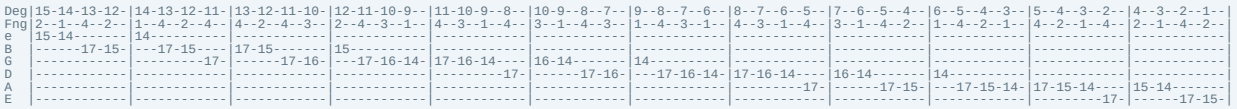
Scale tones: G A B C D E F# G A B C D E F# G

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

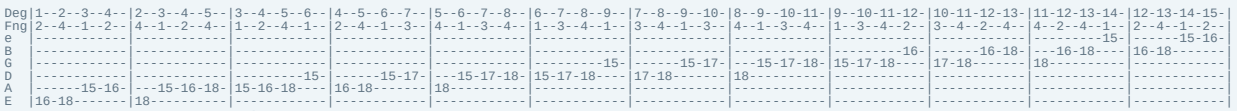
12 AB MAJOR

ROOT E16 | FRAME 15-18

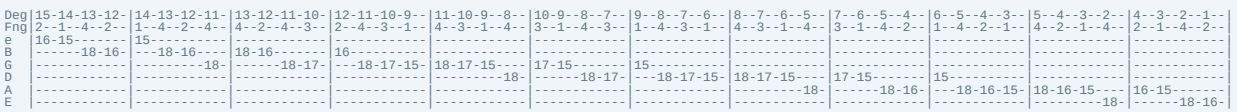
Scale tones: Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab Bb C Db Eb F G Ab

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES



Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Level 17 - Final Rung and Full Round-Trip Challenge

Rung 13: complete the high-A cell at fret 17, then reverse the neck route

Do not replay rung 13 during the down pass unless beginning a new round

13 A MAJOR - OCTAVE

ROOT E17 | FRAME 16-19

Scale tones: A B C# D E F# G# A B C# D E F# G# A

96 NOTES / 24 GROUPS

ASCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

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Deg|1--2--3--4--|2--3--4--5--|3--4--5--6--|4--5--6--7--|5--6--7--8--|6--7--8--9--|7--8--9--10-|8--9--10-11-|9--10-11-12-|10-11-12-13-|11-12-13-14-|12-13-14-15-|
Fng|2--4--1--2--|4--1--2--4--|1--2--4--1--|2--4--1--3--|4--1--3--4--|1--3--4--1--|3--4--1--3--|4--1--3--4--|1--3--4--2--|3--4--2--4--|4--2--4--1--|2--4--1--2--|
e  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------16-|------16-17-|
B  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------17-|------17-19-|---17-19----|17-19-------|
G  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------16-|------16-18-|---16-18-19-|16-18-19----|18-19-------|19----------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|---------16-|------16-18-|---16-18-19-|16-18-19----|18-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
A  |------16-17-|---16-17-19-|16-17-19----|17-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
E  |17-19-------|19----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
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DESCENDING - 12 GROUPS / 48 NOTES

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Deg|15-14-13-12-|14-13-12-11-|13-12-11-10-|12-11-10-9--|11-10-9--8--|10-9--8--7--|9--8--7--6--|8--7--6--5--|7--6--5--4--|6--5--4--3--|5--4--3--2--|4--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--1--4--2--|1--4--2--4--|4--2--4--3--|2--4--3--1--|4--3--1--4--|3--1--4--3--|1--4--3--1--|4--3--1--4--|3--1--4--2--|1--4--2--1--|4--2--1--4--|2--1--4--2--|
e  |17-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
B  |------19-17-|---19-17----|19-17-------|17----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
G  |------------|---------19-|------19-18-|---19-18-16-|19-18-16----|18-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
D  |------------|------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-18-|---19-18-16-|19-18-16----|18-16-------|16----------|------------|------------|
A  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-17-|---19-17-16-|19-17-16----|17-16-------|
E  |------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------19-|------19-17-|
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Return to the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

Continuous alternate picking - D-start and U-start

Full round-trip challenge

Start at A major on low-E fret 5. Play rungs 01-13 without restarting the pick cycle. Reverse after the fret-17 A-major cell and return through rungs 12-01. Say each key name aloud before its first low root. Repeat the complete route with the opposite starting stroke.

ROUTE COUNT 25 cells x 96 notes = 2,400 picked notes.

TEMPO RULE Add 2 BPM after 3 clean trips; reduce 4-6 BPM after 2 errors.

PICK STARTS Complete one D-start round and one U-start round.

Clean-round standard

- No missing, added, or reordered four-note group.
- No pause or accent at a group boundary.
- Correct B-string offset and no open strings.
- Equal volume on both high-root notes at the turn.
- No scrape or tempo change during a one-fret shift.
- Sixteenth-note pulse stays even across all six strings.

Level 17 - Practice Architecture, Variations, and Mastery Gate

Five-phase practice sequence

1. **Ascending half**
   A major only: 12 groups / 48 notes. Keep one group per beat.
2. **Descending half**
   A major only: 12 groups / 48 notes. Practice both pick starts.
3. **Link the turn**
   Play all 96 notes. Alternate across the repeated high root without a reset.
4. **Neighboring rungs**
   Use 2-3 keys and pause one beat only after the complete cell.
5. **Full ladder**
   Remove the pause, climb to fret 17, reverse, and return to fret 5.

Crossing and pulse audit

Group boundary	The rollback begins the next group; the pulse must not hiccup.
String crossing	Keep pick depth shallow and do not accent the landing string.
Middle octave	Position 8 is part of the line, not a place to reset or breathe.
B-string offset	Use the assigned B/high-e geometry instead of copying the G string.
High-root turn	The two position-15 notes are equal and use opposite pick strokes.
Frame shift	Move only after note 96; release pressure before moving one fret.

After the basic ladder is clean

1. Accent note 1 of every group, then remove all group accents.
2. Move the accent to notes 2, 3, and 4 on later passes.
3. Accent only scale positions 1, 8, and 15 wherever they occur.
4. Play two groups per beat at half the metronome marking.
5. Begin selected sessions at fret 17 and descend first.
6. Choose a random root fret 5-17, name the key, and continue either direction.

These are Level 17 variations, not separate full levels.

Mastery gate before Level 18

Complete the full route with continuous sixteenth-note pulse, correct six-string geometry, silent one-fret shifts, and both pick starts on two separate days.

Practice log

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____

Date _____ BPM ____ D/U ____ Clean Y/N ____